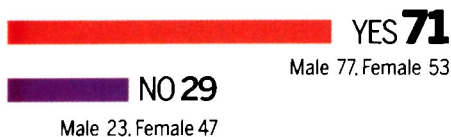


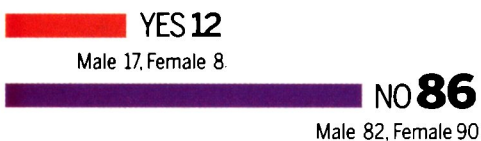
## Have you ever uploaded any of your recorded videos on the Internet?



For 143 respondents of the total 5,371 who had made MMS during sex. All figures in per cent.

**The Pink City is going blue on the Internet. Of all those who video-recorded themselves having sex, 88 per cent respondents in Jaipur admitted to having uploaded their sex videos on the web. In Mumbai it is 85 per cent.**

## Have you ever seen a recorded video or MMS of your friend or relative having sex?



Rest don't know/can't say. All figures in per cent.

imprisonment and the payment of fines.

The electronic, rather than the printed form has turned out to be both the bliss and bane of our collective existence, and nowhere are the paths around this Eden more labyrinthine than in the arena of the sexual. Today, almost every possible fantasy about other people's private sexual acts that one may secretly wish to witness, and whimper over, is a mere (key-)touch away in our techno-saturated, but clearly unsatiated, globalised existence. Are we then within whispering distance of an all-new ailment, voyeur's glut? Does a voyeur's pleasure mutate in knowing that he/she is sharing it with a million unknown others, at that very instant in time, or is there a thrill embedded in a conceptually-orgiastic voyeurism, so to speak? Is the minimising of the world of secret sexual phantasmagoria to a set of luminous screens, of the cellphone, the laptop, the desktop, the television, the multiplex, a reduction of the power and punch of the voyeuristic experience, or is it just that we must redefine what that experience might be for our children, growing up as they are in a world of sexual surfeit?

Increasingly, our greatest voyeuristic pleasures appear to reside in a different notion of the "real" and the "fantasised", aided by and located in technology rather than in peeping through keyholes. And it is perhaps because of the legitimacy afforded by technology that the perception of voyeurism as specifically an illicit, shameful sexual aberration has lost its edge. The emergence of terms such as



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"slum-voyeurism" (in the criticism of *Slumdog Millionaire*, for example) and tourists-as-voyeurs may eventually signify a transformation of what we thought we knew a voyeur to be, one whose sexual pleasure simmers almost wholly in the secrecy of the looking. But voyeurism now appears to be watered down into a perception of a delight derived from gazing at an alien world, its tingle in the spine adduced from a residual association with sexual perversion rather than its own necessary sexual impetus or content. One might wonder whether this is engendered by changing notions about sexual perversion itself, from keeping a horrified, diffident distance to swanning by with a blasé, *sab chalta hai* nonchalance, or whether it is an effect of a steady and growing visual-pleasures-overdose, the much-too-easy accessibility of image creators/receivers/transmitters in the hands of thrill-seekers, and a concomitant desire to twirl private lives in public, so well borne out by the phenomenal epidemic of social networking in cyberspace?

The questions on voyeurism/exhibitionism framed for the sex survey of 2009 reflect our new-found obsession with the camera and its immense foucauldian (fuckauldian?) grip on our sexual imaginations. Indeed, we could read the new voyeurism of our age through Foucault's adoption of Jeremy Bentham's architectural evocation of the panopticon, a structure by which peripheric inmates are watched, isolated, enclosed yet fully visible, while the centre holds the power of the gaze, seeing but not seen. The systematised,